Game Design Document

Commercial in Confidence

REVISION HISTORY

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OVERVIEW

About This Document

This document details the design of *Haunt* for Microsoft's Xbox 360 console platform. Note that *Haunt* is designed for Kinect, and will not be playable without it.

It should be noted that this document is intended to be delivered and read alongside separate documents that detail the specifics of code, art, animation, and audio implementation techniques and investigations.

Please also note that all images used in this document should not be considered final or representative of the final assets that will be seen in the finished game.

Target Audience

Haunt is a first-person perspective adventure/exploration game which leverages Kinect's natural user interface to provide a rich and immersive experience. A tense hunt-or-be-hunted game mechanic provides the level of immersive gameplay depth required to excite Xbox LIVE's **Core Users,** whilst **Hyper Socials** and **Family Timers** can also find enjoyment thanks to the accessible control interface, intuitive gesture-based gameplay and the selection of varied goal-based scenarios.

PILLARS

An immersive haunted house experience that provides spooky scare-based fun for friends and family

New levels of immersion

- Kinect-enabled navigation and interaction
- Sensor and mic input constantly monitored so that your every move and sound can affect the game
- Compelling characters and open-ended background story
- Signature NanaOn-Sha flair in visuals and audio

Horror with Universal Appeal

- Scary, but never terrifying - spooky with a smile!
- In-the-room co-op and group participation
- Creative and fun ways to overcome ghosts that don't involve violence
- Tense game mechanic - hunt whilst being hunted

THE *HAUNT* STORY

The aim of *Haunt's* story is not just to place the player in a believable and conceptually consistent environment, but to encourage the player to play; to give real meaning to their experience. The player is not simply playing through a series of rooms but is instead unfolding a mystery, arriving at shock twists and turns in a plot that adds thrill to the experience rather than being a backdrop.

The overall story sets the scene for the game and maintains your interest, compelling you to continue playing. We believe it's important that the story provides:

- Deep impact in the opening of the game
- An imaginative back-story that draws people in
- An emotional hook

Rather than a heavy, cut-scene based narrative, the story's message and feeling will be manifest in the visuals, gameplay and settings of the scenarios.

Back Story

Please note that game's story as described below represents structure and themes only. The final exposition of the story is to be delivered by NanaOn-Sha.

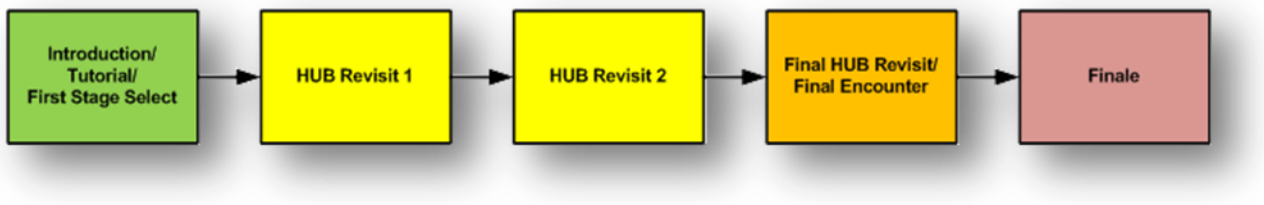
The following is the back-story as described in previous versions of the GDD. This is included for reference only and is subject to change pending final Story delivery from NanaOn-Sha. The themed attraction idea has not been fully developed in the game, and as such will likely change.

One hundred and some years ago, Benjamin Muldoon owned the scariest haunted house attraction that ever existed. Everyone spoke about it. It was a great wonder of its day and Benji was its celebrated curator. But out of the public eye, Benji was a greedy and callous man. So obsessed was he with his eventual rise to enormous wealth and with it celebrity, adulation and of course power, that he forgot about what got him there – his employees.

Benji worked his staff hard, fanatically trying to better his attraction; "It must be more and more frightening than anyone could ever imagine!" he would shout as he mercilessly bullied those poor souls, squeezing every last ounce of effort from them, and yet still demanding more. He left them to work in poor conditions, and made excuses for not paying them, such was his greed. His staff became weak, poor and exhausted. It's no surprise that one by one, they got spooked by the very same terrifying house they helped create, left frightened in the dark until they became ghosts themselves.

Benji was heartless enough that he didn't care about his staff's disappearances; he simply kept his attraction running. He didn't even hire new workers, keeping his costs down. Something was happening though, areas of the house mysteriously started malfunctioning and visitors were going missing inside. As Benji wandered the corridors of his attraction trying to patch up mechanical problems, the ghosts of his staff took their revenge; they spooked Benji, turning him into a ghost in his own haunted house attraction.

Story Structure



The game's story follows the above structure. The aim of each section is described below.

Introduction/ Tutorial

Story Exposition

- The player wakes up in the Grand Hall.
- Benjy introduces himself and tells the player that he has been cursed; stuck inside these paintings in the house, unable to escape.
- Benjy tells the player that they are stuck there too, that there's no point in even trying the doors – there's no way out.
- Benjy reveals that he has a plan, and if you can help him execute it, then he'll be able to help you both out of the house.
- Benjy tells the player that they must collect 4 Magic Talismans from around the house and bring them back to the Great Hall for him so that he can be set free from his curse.

Tutorial

- The player is guided through a tutorial which teaches them the basics of the game
  - Flashlight look system/ turning
  - Walk and navigation system
  - Object interactions
  - Door interactions
  - Collecting items
  - Ghost encounters
  - Magic Talisman Collection
- After the tutorial is complete, the player receives
  - Some story exposition
  - Task to return Magic Talisman to the Grand Hall Statue.
    - Visual cue that Benji is cursed – his statue is surrounded by beams of colored light which emanate from a surrounding at the base of the statue.
    - Benjy explains that these ghostly beams are what have him trapped and that they can only be removed by you; you must collect the various Magic Talisman, plug them into

the base of the statue and perform a 'turn' gesture to unlock the mechanism which powers the beams.

- Introduction to HUB Level Select system

Level Select

- The player is invited to select a level (by choosing a door) and embark on their quest.

HUB Revisits

After the player finishes each stage, they'll return to the HUB to return the Magic Talisman piece.

During each HUB revisit the player will learn a little more about the game's story, as Benjy reveals (both deliberately and inadvertently) more about what exactly is going on:

Story delivered by Benjy

During HUB revisits, Benjy updates the player on some aspects of the game's story

- Benjy updates the player on who the 'bad' ghosts are, and why they have trapped him there
- Benjy will update the player on what exactly happened to you
- Benjy reveals how you and he will escape after you free him

Inadvertent clues

From slip-ups that Benjy makes, the player can begin to understand that all may not be as it seems, and that Benjy may not be the friendly character that he appeared to be. In fact, he may be attempting to trick the player. This should not be explicit, but something the player feels they are finding out for themselves.

- Benjy slips into discussing 'my' escape rather than 'our' escape
- Benjy appears more power-hungry and manic as the game progresses
- The collected newspaper clippings hint to the player that Benjy was a nasty piece of work

Final HUB Revisit/ Final Encounter

After the player has completed the final level, their return to the Grand Hall with the final Magic Talisman will trigger the final encounter in the game, in the form of a multiple ghost encounter.

This final encounter uses all the themed ghosts from the game who each attack the player in turn, aggressively. The player must defend themselves correctly and attack with their multiple abilities, remembering and choosing the correct defense and attack action for each ghost.

- Each ghost attacks the player in turn, the player using everything they have learned about themed ghosts in the games stages to survive and win.
- Benjy VO at this point focuses on encouraging the player to keep the ghosts away from him, and to hurry up and defeat them.
- By now, Benjy's tone is harsh and aggressive, almost manic.

Finale

- Following the final multiple-ghost encounter, the player is free to return the final Magic Talisman and remove the last barrier to lift the curse on Benjy.
- The player uses the Magic Talisman to remove the final ghostly barrier surrounding Benjy'statue; it fades and the statue seems to take on a spiritual glow which surges all over it.
- The player can hear Benjy ranting about his return to power, now that he's free from his imprisonment in the paintings. He seems to no longer speaking to the player but rather shouting angrily at some unseen enemy.
- Benjy's talk suddenly turns to the player. He reveals that he never intended to help the player escape, but that he needed someone to lift the curse, and to take his place.
- As the player becomes aware that Benjy is the real villain of the piece, his statue is bathed in light and in a blinding flash, it disappears.
- A ball of light emerges in place of Benjy's statue – it's his spirit; "now I just need to find myself a body. Thanks for all your help, friend! Enjoy your stay. HAHAHA" he yells as he shoots off across the room and towards a door to make his escape.
- Benjy reveals that he is not the good companion that the player thought, but rather that he has planned all along to trap the player in his place.
- As Benjy's spirit flees, the light on the statue fades and reveals a new statue in it's place – that of the player's Xbox Avatar, rendered in stone.
- The camera zooms in to a plaque below the player's Avatar statue; the player's gamertag is carved into the bronze plaque.
- The camera turns around and looks at the large Benjy painting in the Grand Hall, showing the player's live feed, trapped in a frame. The player is trapped in Benjy's place!
- The camera quickly pulls into the painting, and turns around to face out into the room from the painting position, the player's eye view. There is a frame visible around the edge of the screen. Benji can be heard laughing.
- The camera pans out from the player trapped in the painting. Music starts and Credits roll.
- After the credit sequence, the music fades and we focus on a shot of the main door. After a short pause, from out of the silence, there is a knock at the door. *knock knock*…

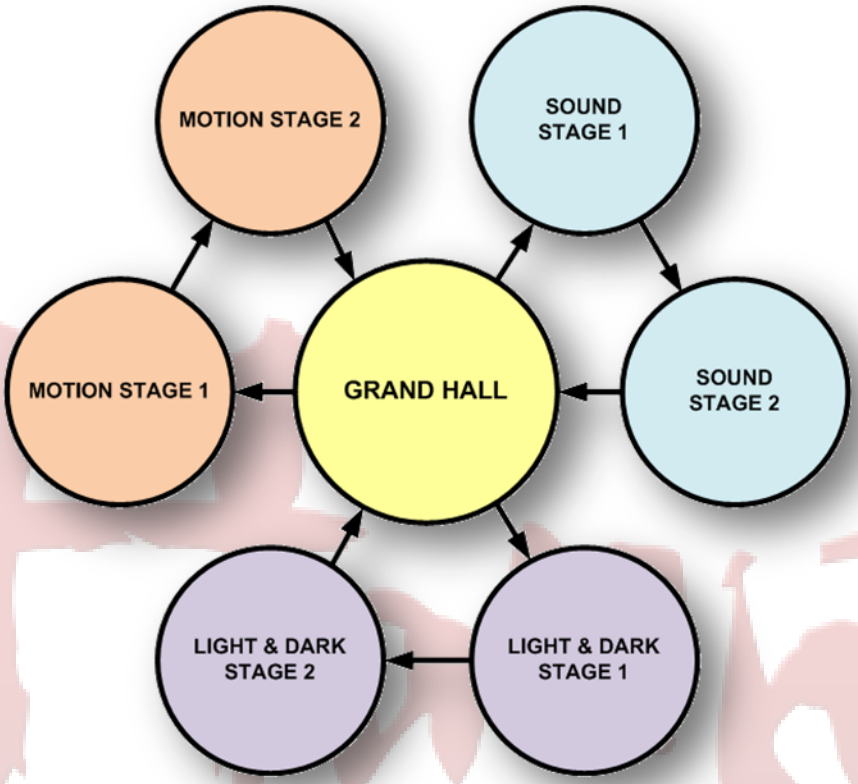
This ending offers an opportunity to continue the game and the same story thread via DLC or in a sequel.

One option for continuation of the same thread in DLC would be to reintroduce the Frankie character originally planned for the game, with Benjy possessing\creating Frankie's body in an effort to escape the mansion.

Another possibility is to have the character who knocks at the door be the person who trapped Benjy in the paintings in the first place, come to sort out the mess you've caused, offering to free you so that you can undo all you've done...

GAME STRUCTURE

The following diagram illustrates the structure of the game as a whole:



The following describes the modular structure of a "level" in *Haunt*, and applies to pre-authored levels.

A level consists of:

- An **overall Goal** (or combination of goals)
- A **number of Stages** that make up the level

Each stage is made up of:

- A **Room** (or number of rooms)
- An **Objective** (or number of objectives)
- An **Action** (or number of actions)

Levels and Stages

Levels

- The game will feature 3 Themed Levels and the Grand Hall, offering roughly 3 hours of pre authored gameplay.
- Each level will last around 30~40 minutes (From experience, around 30 minutes seems to be an ideal length for an uninterrupted play session with a motion control game).
- Each themed level has 2 stages; one where the player is introduced to the theme and its mechanics, and one where it uses the themed mechanics and abilities to progress.

Stages

- There are roughly 4 to 6 rooms in a stage
- Players who quit and return to a session will restart at the beginning of the stage they are currently playing.
- Each stage has, roughly, 1 to 3 goals (e.g. defeat ghosts, find key, exit stage)
- Stages are filled with Spirit Essence and collectibles to promote full exploration of the stage.

Other Areas

Grand Hall

The game begins in the Grand Hall and this is where all elements of narrative exposition are delivered to the player.

The player returns to the Grand Hall after finishing each level. On each occasion, the Hall has changed subtly – the lighting has changed and Spirit Essence placement has repopulated etc.

Other Rooms

One room in the grand hall cannot be accessed and is marked as 'Closed for Maintenance'. This is used to prepare the player for the appearance of Downloadable Content.

Non-Linear Progression

The three themed levels in the game are also playable in any order. This allows the player a sense of freedom and capitalizes on the exploration element of the game. Themed levels also allow us to organize gameplay systems together in a meaningful way, allowing us to tailor the gameplay in each level around the central theme.

Replaying a Stage

On completion of any stage, the player is presented with the Results Screen.

The results screen gives the player their scoring information for the stage they just played also offers the player the ability to 'Replay' the level they have just played or 'Continue'. If the player chooses to 'Replay' the level, then they will start again at the beginning of the level they have just played, will all puzzles and encounters reset to their original states as if they had never been played. If the player selects 'Continue' then they will be returned to the Grand Hall HUB and must choose the next level to play.

Ghosts and Other Characters

Haunt will include a variety of different ghosts to avoid or battle, as well as one key 'character' to help drive the narrative – Benjy. The different ghost types will exhibit similar basic behaviour (e.g. floating, popping out of objects etc), but each will have a unique look, attacks and methods of defeating them.

Ghosts

Ghosts appear regularly throughout the game, and are the main threat to the player. There are several different types of ghost. Most ghosts will share the same basic body model, but a different head, essentially looking like a different ghost to the player. Each distinct ghost variation represents variation in the ghost behavior. This includes:

- Different attack patterns (e.g. different patterns in throwing objects at the player)
- Different movement patterns (e.g. how often they move, and where they move to before attacking the player)
- Differences in strength (how vulnerable the ghost is against player attacks)

Examples in attack, defence and susceptibility of common ghosts in themed levels are shown below:

Common Ghost Type	Description
Charger Ghost	Found throughout the whole game, these ghosts are most often one-shot deals designed to give the player a quick scare and prompt a quick reaction. They simply charge towards the player, requiring the player to dodge left or right, or duck to avoid being hit and losing Spirit Essence. Alternatively, Charger Ghosts are occasionally found patrolling an area of the level. In these cases the player can choose to avoid the ghost by remaining silent and avoiding detection until it has moved away.
Brute Ghost	Appearing throughout the game, this ghost likes to get up close and attack the player with swipes of its arms which the player must duck or jump to the side to avoid. This ghost is susceptible to a close-range physical attack from the player in the form of a 'punch'. When the ghost has been punched, it reels back and becomes dazed, allowing the player to use their flashlight to harm the ghost.
Screamer Ghost	Appearing only in the Sound and HUB Levels, this ghost attacks the player with an ear-splitting scream. Players can defend against their attacks by covering their ears.

	The ghost becomes dazed if the player uses a Thrust gesture immediately after the ghost's attack. This ghost can be attacked with the flashlight, but is much more susceptible to the player screaming back at it.
Blinder Ghost	Appearing only in the Light & Dark and HUB Levels, this ghost attacks by emitting a blinding light from its eyes. This ghost's attack can be defended against by the player looking away and covering their face to block out the light. The ghost becomes dazed if the player uses a Thrust gesture immediately after the ghost's attack. This ghost can be attacked with the flashlight, but is much more susceptible to defeat by the player drawing a magic symbol on it with their flashlight.
Thrower Ghost	Appearing only in the Motion and HUB Levels, this ghost attacks by repeatedly throwing ghostly projectiles at the player. The player can defend themselves by 'burning' off these projectiles with their flashlight before they reach the player and harm them. Occasionally, the thrower ghost throws real objects, which the player cannot burn off and must duck or lean to avoid. Players must wait until the ghost has thrown the real object and enters a 'dazed' recharge state, during this time, the player can use their flashlight as a tractor beam to pull the ghost towards them. When the ghost is pulled in close enough, the player can 'kick' the ghost, volleying it around the room and harming it. When the player has acquired the deflect ability, they can volley the ghost objects back at the ghost to daze it more quickly.

Bats

Bats can be used as triggered scares, or can be disturbed by the player which will cause them to attack. Bats will fly at the player in one big cloud, which the player will have to defend against until it passes. Players can defend against bats by flailing their arms around wildly.

PLAYER ACTIONS

The player interacts with the *Haunt* world in a number of ways:

- **Navigation** – Moving around the *Haunt* world
- **Object Interactions** – How the player interacts with objects and furniture they find along the way
- **Ghost Encounters** – How the player fends off and interacts with ghosts in the house

Each of these actions has its own unique way to interact with the game through the Kinect interface.

The areas in which player experience should be focused on in *Haunt* are the game's events (ghost encounters and object encounters). Kinect can be used in these areas to its fullest extent, offering the player a truly new experience and intuitive controller free interaction in a number of ways.

Details regarding what player actions are required for navigation, object interactions or ghost encounters can be found in the following sections of this document.

NAVIGATION

The player navigates the *Haunt* world in first person view.

General Navigation Conventions

Moving Around a Room

Moving around the room is controlled by 'aiming' the flashlight.

The player can move in the direction that their flashlight is pointing by simply walking on the spot.

The current system provides a 1:1 relationship between the player's movement and that of their in-game movement. The system has a lot of technology under the hood in order to provide a robust and intuitive experience (in particular, across a wide range of users), which we believe to be more immersive and less frustrating than the other methods investigated during pre-production.

- **Robustness** – We've made excellent progress in this area, and have implemented tracking of leg height movement to make the system more robust. This strong tech foundation allows us to better the user experience side of the system so that the game more accurately reflects what the player feels should be happening with their movement.
- **Flashlight Navigation** –The flashlight has benefited from improvements to latency, and now runs via an intelligent system which looks for forearm positioning. When forearm position cannot be found by the skeleton tracking system, the game increases the movement buffer for the flashlight, minimizing any jitter caused by Kinect trying to 'best guess' the player's forearm position.
- **Skeleton Tracking Latency** – The skeleton tracking system in the game can be made more reliable, but there is a trade-off between the reliability of the system and its latency; the more **robust** the system is, the more it cross-references Kinect data with data about the player's actions over the last several frames. The larger the buffer where we can analyze what the player intends to do, the longer the latency. This will remain under balancing scrutiny, and will be constantly improved throughout the project.
- **Object Collision** – Further to the reliability and increased stability, we have implemented collision with objects, so that players are now 'pushed' around an object when it blocks their path, reducing the likelihood of the player getting stuck on objects and doors.

Navigation Implementation

Players' movement around a room is tied to 'nodes' automatically positioned in that room at regular square intervals. Nodes cannot be seen by players and are purely a technical entity.

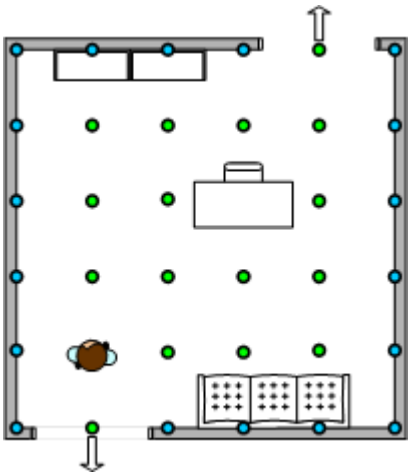


Figure 12 - Example room with nodes

When the player selects an area to move to, the game calculates where the nearest node to the destination is, draws a path to that node, and allows the player to move to that point by walking on the spot.

If an object is in the direct line of sight of the player and their destination, then the player will not be able to proceed through that object, the player must navigate around the object. The game supports this by simply sliding the player around objects as the player collides with them.

Nodes are also positioned on walls at 1m intervals, related to the nearest floor node. This allows the player to move to an area in the distance where they may not be able to see the floor. They will arrive positioned at the nearest node to the wall node, 1m away from it.

None of this is visible to the player. The player's experience is essentially that they point the flashlight in front of them and walk to move forward, unless there is an object or a wall in the way.

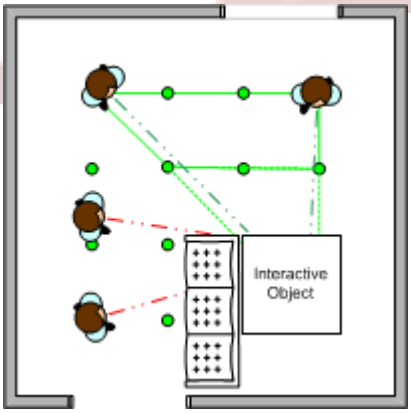


Figure 13 – The player must be able to move to a position where they can see an object, to interact with it

It's important that the player is able to use nodes to move around a room as well as just selecting objects in that room to interact with. In the diagram above, if the player wants to interact with the object, then they must move to a position in the room where they can see the object clearly.

This approach to movement around rooms provides a controllable but seemingly free-flowing movement to the player, allowing them to explore their environment thoroughly by getting into every nook and cranny, rather than just observing every possible interaction in a room from any point within that room.

Freeform and Assured Navigation

Several approaches to the usability of the navigation system have been investigated and following feedback, 2 systems are currently implemented; Freeform Navigation and Assured Navigation. Intention is that these will be available as a selectable option in the Help & Settings menu of the game, to offer both hardcore and casual player to play in the style that suits them.

These options are described below:

Freeform Navigation

Freeform Navigation (the game's default setting) allows the player to move around the environment as they wish. Collision with an object while the player is propelling themselves forward in-game is handled by sliding the player along the object until they are free.

Freeform navigation makes only very minimal effort to assume what the player's intention is, offering as it does a more accurate and less intrusive experience to the player.

We feel that it's important to include a freeform navigation option, as this seems to be the method favored by people who have played the game more and those looking for a more immersive player experience.

Assured Navigation

Assured Navigation helps more casual players and those less familiar with the Freeform Navigation system avoid frustration with a more complex control system.

Assured Navigation attempts to assume the player's intention as much as possible and assist the player in the following ways:

- Automatic turning around corners while the player remains simply facing forwards and walking.
- Thinning of corridor collision to make players' movement in corridors more naturally occur in the direction of the corridor's length, helping the player avoid walking into walls and becoming disorientated.
- Automatic turning away from objects that the player is colliding with (e.g. walking into a wall, the player will be turned slowly to face the direction of the corridor)

This navigation method is likely to be favored by new players and players new to Kinect and first person games, but may result in a more frustrating and 'too-easy' experience for seasoned gamers.

OBJECT INTERACTIONS

Throughout the game, players will come across a variety of objects that they can interact with. Once a player chooses to interact with an object, they effectively leave the navigational aspect of the game, and are seamlessly transitioned into a controlled object interaction in which they perform an action to cause an effect.

Selecting an Object

If the player is close enough to an interactive object, then when their flashlight beam is pointed at it, the object will glow. This informs the player that this object is interactive and not just part of the room furniture.

To interact with an object, the player should hold their beam in position, pointed at the interactive object. As the flashlight focuses on the object, the beam thins and eventually triggers the interaction, moving the player into position in front of the 'selected' object.

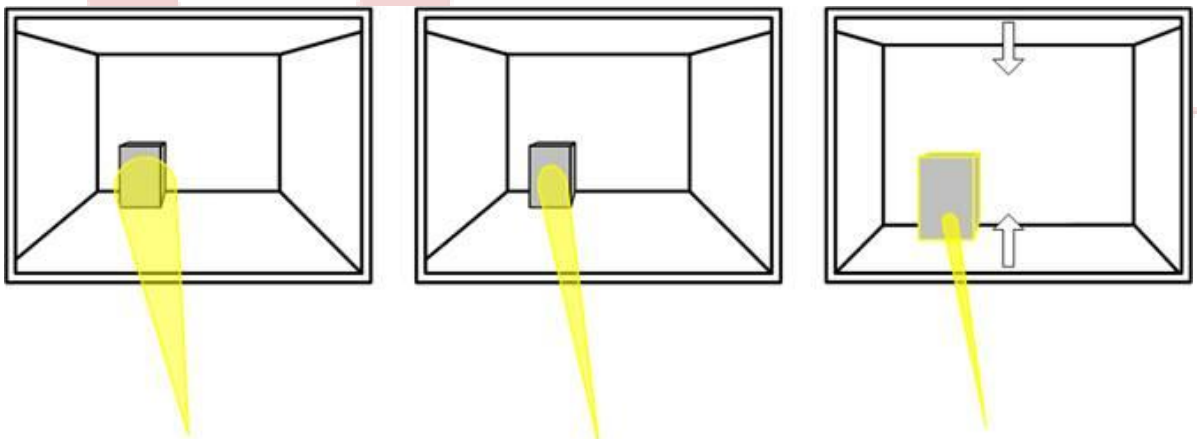


Figure 11 – Flashlight focuses if held still over object

As long as the player moves the beam away from the selected object before the beam focuses completely, then the beam will begin to return to its full size, cancelling the interaction.

Quick Focusing

To speed up the process of interacting with an object, players can perform a sharp 'thrusting' gesture with their flashlight hand whilst holding their beam over object they wish to interact with. This will immediately trigger the object interaction event.

Real Objects

Each object will have a specific interaction type which should be obvious or familiar to players. The intention is that each object should behave in the way most obvious i.e. as it would in the real world.

The following list details some example objects that appear in the levels designed for the game so far, and the interactions that the player will need to perform to use each object. More examples of potential objects, their interaction types and potential rewards can be found in the separate 'Haunt – Level Design Document'.

Object	Objective	Interaction	Reward
Drawer	Find items inside	Pull open	Item/Spirit Essence
Bells	Play tune	Pull bells in correct order	Tune played, puzzle solved
Cupboard	Find items inside	Pull open doors	Item/Spirit Essence
Intercom	Gain access to room	Speak into mouthpiece	Access room

Objects can only be interacted with using one action. A door, for example, can only be opened by using the 'Open' action.

Furthermore, objects that can be opened can generally be closed too. For example, once a drawer has been pulled open, it can be pushed shut again. In the majority of cases this will cause the object interaction event to be exited automatically.

Exiting Object Interactions

Many object interaction events will be exited automatically once the required action has been performed by the player. However, in some cases the player will require a means to exit the interaction in order to continue the game. We also want to ensure that players can exit an interaction once they have entered into it, if they then decide they do not want to interact with the object.

When it is possible to exit an interaction, an icon will be displayed in the top left corner of the screen to show players how to do so. This icon will clearly show players that they simply need to raise their left hand up towards the ceiling at a 45 degree angle, which will fill a radial button and then exit the interaction.

GHOST ENCOUNTERS

During the game, players will encounter numerous Ghosts. These vary in type according to their attack. Encounters with these Ghosts will vary in length and difficulty.

Beginning an Encounter

An encounter with a Ghost could begin in a number of ways. It may come as a surprise, as a result of a specific game event (e.g. solving a puzzle), or it may be instigated by the player. Some ghosts will only attack once before fleeing again, whereas other encounters may be a battle that lasts up to a minute in length, or anything in between. There are a variety of behaviors that we can potentially attribute to a ghost to determine how the player encounters it. These may include:

- Hide to jump out and scare the player
- Disappear then reappear elsewhere
- Evade the player
- Guard an object or doorway

Ghost Behavior

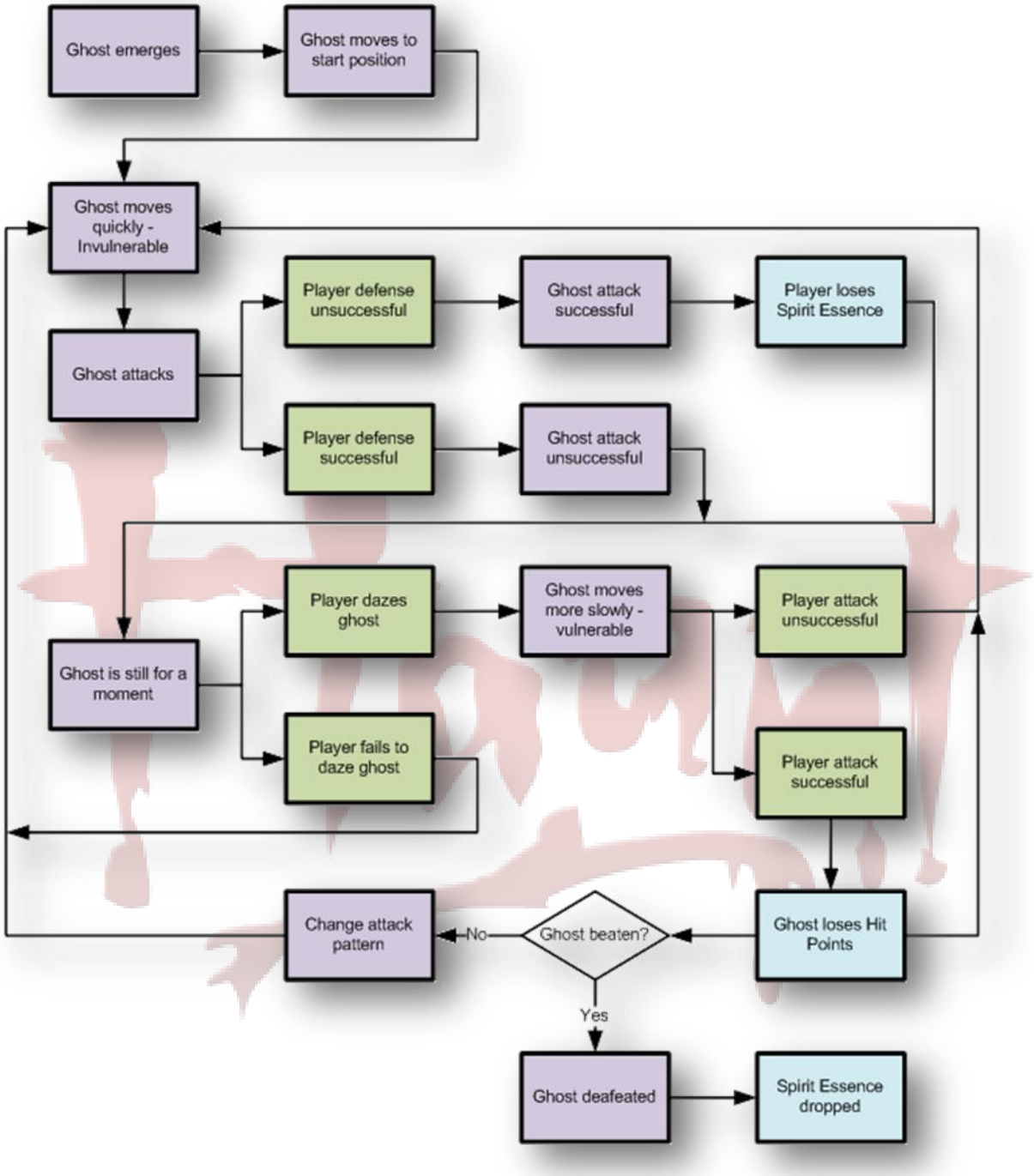
Upon a Ghost Encounter being triggered (usually via an interaction), the Ghost will enter an Attack Loop process. While this process is in effect player navigation controls are disabled, and general camera movement will be controlled by the game. In this instance, the player can still move the flashlight around the screen, but they cannot change the viewing direction or angle.

If the Ghost being encountered has an attack that can use varying patterns (e.g. throwing objects to the left and right of the player), its attack pattern can be varied each Attack Loop to keep things interesting and unpredictable.

While each type of ghost has a different way of attacking or being harmed by the player, there are general similarities between ghosts:

- Ghosts generally attack the player, and the player must perform a Kinect specific action (i.e. Duck, cover ears) to defend.
- The player can generally harm ghosts by getting them into a dazed or vulnerable state by performing a specific Kinect action (e.g. Punch, Thrust)
- Ghosts are generally harmed of affected by the flashlight, but in different ways.
- When players have acquired themed abilities, this allows them to weaken ghosts more quickly by performing that ability.

The diagram below provides an example of a particular ghost encounter, showing its logic and use of states:

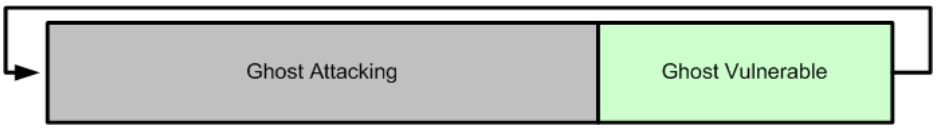


The variation in this pattern comes from varying the following parameters:

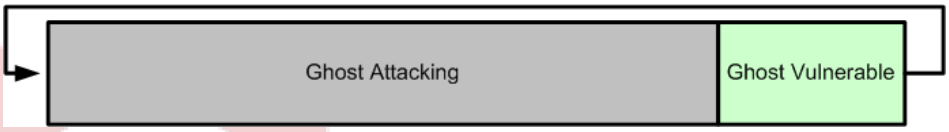
Ghost Type
Ghost “Attack”/ Interaction Type
Player “Defense”/ “Attack” Tactic

Reward

In the 'Attack Loop' diagram above, there is a period of ghost vulnerability. During this period the player can damage a ghost and ultimately defeat them. An example of this is shown below



As the game progresses, difficulty can be varied simply by changing the ratio of Ghost Attack time to Ghost Vulnerable time, shortening the window within which the player can inflict damage on a ghost. The number of times that this loop must be completed successfully also affects the game's difficulty.



Ghost Classes

The class of a ghost determines its behavior, how much damage it can take and how much damage it can deal. We have identified the following classes:

Easy – These ghosts (Charger Ghosts) appear very briefly, attacking only once before disappearing again. These ghosts do not require players to attack, only to defend.

Normal – These ghosts use an attack loop process. The player has to both defend and attack such ghosts, though they have a relatively small damage threshold.

For more information about the types of ghost we plan to implement in *Haunt*, please refer to the 'Ghosts and Other Characters' section of this document.

Ghost Interactions

During an encounter with a Ghost the player will be called upon to interact using several different mechanics in order to defend against ghost attacks, and perform their own attacks while a ghost is vulnerable. Please note that the interaction ideas listed here are subject to be tested, modified, or replaced during development.

Defense Interactions

Each type of Ghost Attack can be defended against with a specific Defense Interaction by the player:

Dodge (Lean left or right, Duck) – This can be used to defend against Charging Ghosts, Brute Ghosts or Thrower Ghosts.

Cover Ears – This action can be used to defend against Screamer Ghosts.

Shield Eyes – This action can be used to defend against Blinder Ghosts.

Burn – This action can be used to burn off projectiles thrown by Thrower Ghosts.

General Attack Interactions

The methods described here vary from ghost to ghost, but generally, a similar process applied to all ghosts.

After a ghost has attacked, there is a window of opportunity in which the player can perform a specific gesture to daze the ghost. Whilst dazed, the ghost will move around more slowly than usual, and is vulnerable to attack.

While the ghost is in this vulnerable state the player can harm it by using their flashlight beam. The use of the flashlight beam and its effect varies from ghost to ghost, as described in the previous table in this document. This is the player's standard method for attacking and defeating ghosts.

Special Attack Interactions

Throughout the game, players will earn new abilities to use when faced with ghost encounters. Each type of ghost will have a special attack that it is particularly susceptible to. These attacks will cause much more damage than the standard attack, but can be used in conjunction with the standard attack by clever players to cause even greater damage.

Scream – The player screams at the Ghost.
Symbol – The player uses their flashlight to paint a Magic Symbol over the Ghost.
Deflect – This action is used to rebound objects thrown by Thrower ghosts back at them, causing them harm.

Please note: These abilities may also be used outside of ghost encounters for particular puzzles. For more details please refer to the 'Haunt – Level Design Document'.

Attack Loops and Health

With each attack loop, the player has a chance to daze the ghost and attack it while it is vulnerable. If successful in attacking a Ghost, it will lose some of its health. The amount of health lost is dependent on the attack being used. For example, the standard attack may take a small amount of health, whereas a special attack may take a large amount of health. Exact figures are to be determined during balancing.

Defeating Ghosts

Once an attacking ghost's health has been depleted, the ghost will fade away, leaving behind valuable Spirit Essence for the player to collect. Once defeated, the same ghost will not appear again during the stage.

PUZZLES

As players make their way through *Haunt*'s levels and stages they will come across certain problems that they must solve in order to progress further. These "puzzles" could entail simply finding a key to unlock a door, or involve more complex sequences of actions requiring multiple interactions.

Puzzles in *Haunt* will generally involve object interactions executed in sequence or in parallel to reach a goal. This will often also include an element of exploration (by navigation).

Please refer to the stage designs detailed in the 'Haunt – Level Design Document' document for specific examples of the puzzles we intend to implement in the game.

Puzzle Complexity

Puzzles can vary in complexity and length ranging from very simple problems solved with single interactions, to entire stages involving multiple interactions. Some stages include more than one puzzle, though in cases there is not more than one complex problem to solve, instead a complex puzzle is partnered with a much simpler puzzle – often linked to the more complex problem by means of a clue.

Puzzle Themes

Puzzles can be grouped by their overarching themes. This makes it easier us to plan where puzzles should occur on the game timeline, ensuring puzzles with fundamental similarities can be bunched together or be separated, as appropriate.

We have identified the following puzzle themes as being desirable:

- **Audio** – These puzzles focus on using sound. E.g. pulling bells in the correct order to play a tune.
- **Light** – These puzzles focus on using light and darkness. E.g. using a camera flash to light a crystal.
- **Movement** – These puzzles focus on motion and timing. E.g. 'freezing' on the spot to avoid a trap.
- **Logic** – These puzzles focus on interactions between objects. E.g. finding a key to open a door

SCARES

A pillar of *Haunt* is to provide scare-based fun by means of "horror with universal appeal". We believe this is achievable by relying on atmospherics and the element of surprise, rather than on violence and gore to shock the player.

Aside from the general look and feel of the game, the story narrative and the main ghost interactions, we will use 'Scares' to enhance the player's experience and feeling of immersion. These devices could appear anywhere in a stage, but they generally fall into two distinct categories:

- **Subtle Scares** – Simple sound effects and slight visual changes to enhance the atmosphere
- **Surprises** – Unexpected sudden noises and visual effects prompting involuntary player reactions

Please refer to the stage designs detailed in the 'Haunt – Level Design Document' document for specific examples of the scares we intend to implement in the game.

Scare Triggers

Scares will require several different trigger methods to ensure the desired effect is achieved. Here are some examples of potential trigger behaviors, along with examples of what kind of scare may use such behaviors:

- **Proximity (Near)** – E.g. As the player passes by a suit of armor, the visor shuts with a loud noise.
- **Proximity (Far)** – E.g. The player notices a door slam shut from a distance.
- **Object Interaction** – E.g. A ghost flies out from a cupboard as the player opens it.
- **Room Entered**- E.g. Thunder claps immediately as the player enters the room.
- **Room Exited** – E.g. A telephone rings whenever the player leaves the room.
- **Player View** – E.g. A shadow cast by lightning on the wall in the player's peripheral field of vision.
- **Random** – E.g. Randomly triggered sound effects such as footsteps or thunderclaps.

Red Herrings

In instances where a Scare device is attributed to an object (e.g. a suit of armor), we reuse that asset several times but only allow the associated Scare to happen on very few occasions in order to maintain suspense. By the same token, Scare devices will only activate once per stage, so the player doesn't get the same Scare happen every time they pass the same instance of the Scare device.

KINECT SPECIAL FEATURES

As well as with the navigation, interaction and action sequences, we feel that it's important that Kinect is as much of a spectacle for the player as possible.

There are a number of cool features achievable in a game like *Haunt*:

Image sampling – During specific scripted moments when the player is in a particular interaction, the game takes a still image of the player. This treated still image can appear in the game in a number of ways

- **Portraits** – A framed treatment of the player can be seen in paintings found by observant players.
- **Dark Room Photos** – A series of photos treated in monochrome, hanging up during development in a dark room in the game.

Speech sampling - During normal play, audio samples are recorded. Later on, a treated and warped version that sample is played back to the player.

- **Names** – the player states their name during normal play. Later the player is shocked to hear a treated, spooky version of their own name repeated to them down an earpiece during an interaction with a telephone.

These devices can of course be used to trick the player into a mild state of uneasiness, but more importantly, they maximise the player's immersion in the game; "*I'm on a newspaper clipping in the game!?*" "*…A painting of me!?*".

For practical examples of how we are intending to implement these features, please refer to the 'Haunt – Level Design Document' document.

HUD

To provide the most immersive experience, *Haunt* will generally use a minimal HUD. Furthermore, wherever possible, elements that are required to communicate information to the player will be integrated into the environment.

HUD Elements

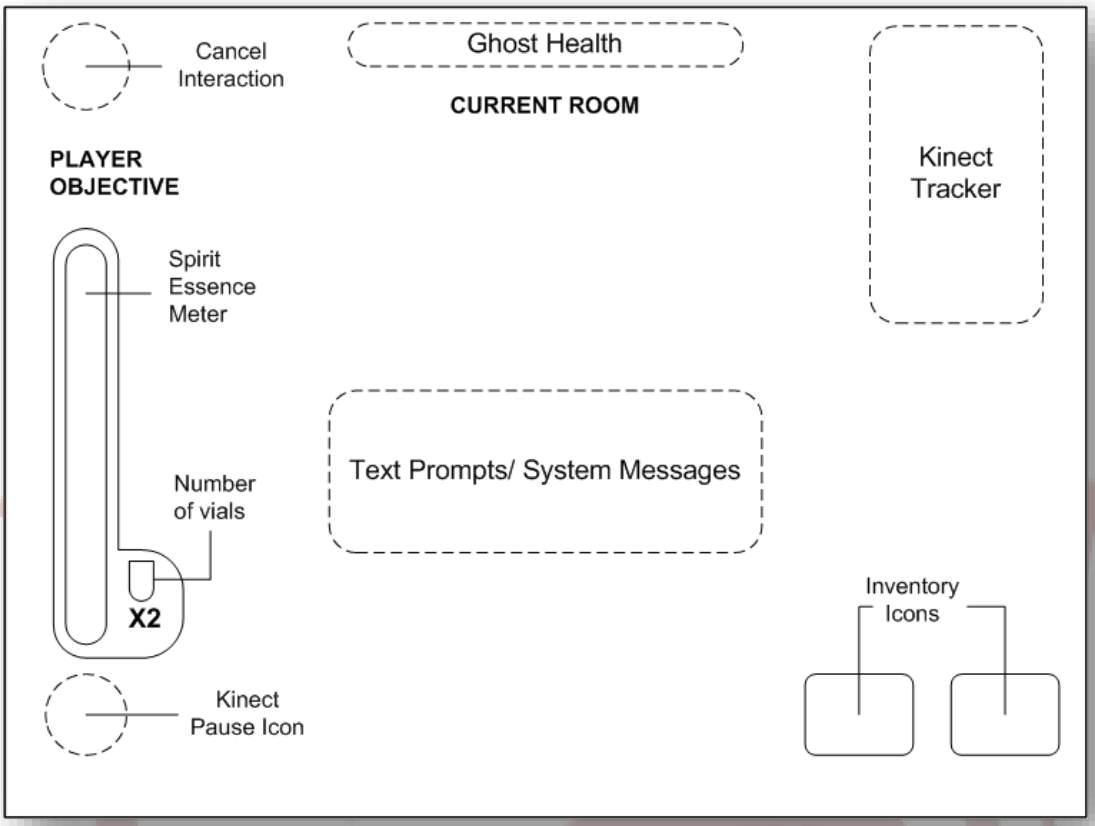
In our current plan, the following HUD elements are expected to be required:

- **Hand Icons** – These appear when the player has their hand over an interactive object, such as a door, and will communicate to the player what kind of hand movement is required to interact with the object.
- **Inventory Slot (full)** – When an inventory item is picked up by the player, an icon will appear onscreen to show that item has been collected.
- **Inventory Slot (empty)** – When the player tries to interact with an object that requires an inventory item that they do not possess, an empty icon indicating the silhouette of the required item will appear onscreen.
- **Spirit Essence** – A meter displayed onscreen to indicate the player's current amount of Spirit Essence.
- **Vials** – Shows the number of 'rejuvenation' vials the player has.
- **Text Prompts** – These will be used to communicate specific actions or events to the player, for example a prompt to "Duck" during a Ghost encounter.
- **Cancel Interaction** – Graphic displayed only when the player is in an interaction, showing them how to cancel and return to navigation.
- **Kinect System Elements** – These will be required to adhere to the Kinect TCR standards, for example a 'pause' function triggered by the player holding their left arm out to their side.

Titles using a similar player perspective often show a mini map or compass (or both) to guide the player to their objectives. This will not be necessary as *Haunt's* stages are made up of relatively few rooms.

HUD Layout

The following diagram shows potential HUD layout consideration for Haunt. It is very unlikely that the amount of icons on the screen mock-up below will be shown at the same time.



System message icons (e.g. Kinect Pause icon, in- room position indicator) are less in keeping with the game's styling and will be treated with a different aesthetic consideration (they will move on to and off of the screen in a way that makes them look like different elements from the game's HUD elements).

The icons outlined in bold above are likely to be required onscreen at all times, whereas the icons shown with dotted outlines are likely to appear onscreen only when the situation dictates.

For a detailed HUD asset list and aesthetic considerations, please see the Media Design Document.

SCORING

Haunt is primarily about the experience of exploring and escaping from a haunted mansion, rather than a competitive score based game. However, the ability to rate players against each other is still important for online leaderboards.

In Haunt, the player accrues score as they play. Ultimately, this score is shared in the games online Leaderboard.

Scoring System

At the end of each level, the player is given a score, based on the following factors:

- Number of ghosts defeated (e.g. 2 of 4 ghosts defeated)
- Newspaper clippings found (e.g 2 of 4)
- Total SE lost (e.g. -30)

These values are then used in an equation (to be determined in balancing) to arrive at a score.

An example of how this would be calculated might be:

	Percentage of Ghosts Defeated x 1,000	(80 x 1000) = 80,000
+	Number of Newspaper Clippings Found x 10,000	(2 x 10,000) = 20,000
—	Total Spirit Essence Lost x 1000	(30 x 1,000) = 30,000
=	TOTAL SCORE	70,000 Points

Note - This equation is an example, and will be altered suitably to arrive at sets of scores which promote competition among players and reflect the appropriate values of tasks and collectibles in the game.

Results Screen

After each Level, the player will be presented with a Results screen, showing the player's score for the level they just played through and giving them the opportunity to better their score before moving on.

COLLECTIBLES

This section details Collectibles for *Haunt* that are placed throughout the game stages to add to the sense of player discovery and increase scoring and competitive value. These Collectibles fall into two categories; rewards that directly improve the player's experience, and items that reveal more of the game's back-story.

Spirit Essence Vials

A vial that is already full of spirit essence. Collecting this immediately gains the player an extra life.

Some will be placed in locations that are difficult to miss, whilst others will be used as rewards for discovering secret areas or solving optional puzzles.

Newspaper Clippings

Newspaper Clippings reveal some of the game's back-story, and give player's gradual insight into what may have happened to the house and its residents/employees. These require the player to collect and return the clipping to the Grand Hall, where it will be added to a specific area (a pin-board) and build up a collage of back-story for the game. An Achievement is awarded for finding all of the Clippings hidden around the house.

HEALTH, DEATH AND RESPAWN

This section of the document explains the concepts of Spirit Essence as Health and the game's handling of 'death' and 'Game Over'.

Spirit Essence

Spirit Essence is a ghostly substance which represents the player's and other character's 'health' in the game. Spirit essence can be acquired by several methods:

- Found in drawers, cabinets, under beds etc
- Found in nooks and crannies within rooms and corridors
- Left behind by ghosts who have been beaten by the player

When Spirit Essence is found inside interactive objects, such as cupboards and drawers, or is spawned after a successful encounter, it is collected automatically. When Spirit Essence is found simply lying around, the player must cast their flashlight beam over it and hold it there for a moment to collect it.

During ghost encounters, the player must defend against attacks. The goal of a player in a ghost event is essentially to survive a ghost attack to maintain their own Spirit Essence level, and eventually defeat a ghost to gain some more Spirit Essence.

The player's health at any time can be determined by viewing the spirit essence meter on the left hand side of the game screen.

Lives System

In *Haunt*, the player starts the game with 3 lives. If a player runs out of Spirit Essence (health) then the game will effectively be paused, the screen will fade to black and the player will see a Spirit Essence vial (shown on the right of their spirit essence meter below) deplete. The player's Spirit Essence level in the main SE meter will then refill and the game will resume from where the player left off.

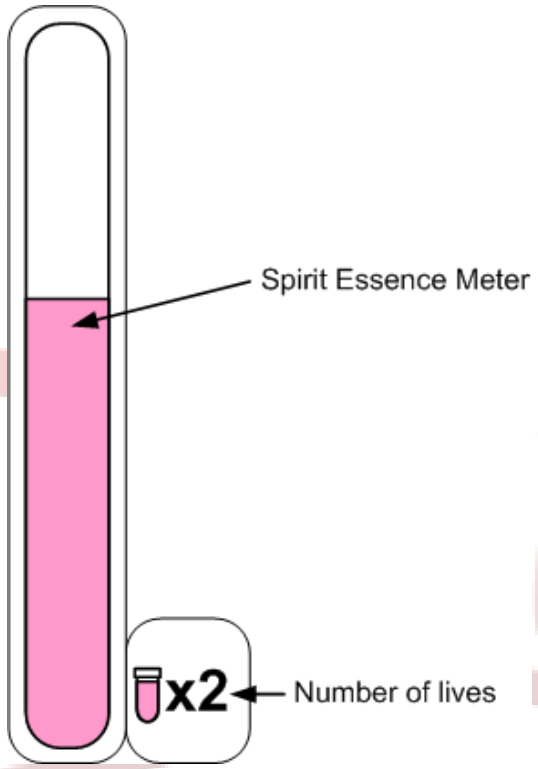
If a player has used all of their Spirit Essence vials and runs out of Spirit Essence in the main meter, they will 'die' and be presented with a 'game over' message and an option to 'retry' that stage or 'quit'. If the player opts to retry the stage, then they will start the stage again with all stage states reset as if the level had never been played.

If the player opts to 'quit' they will be returned to the game's main menu.

Spirit Essence Vials

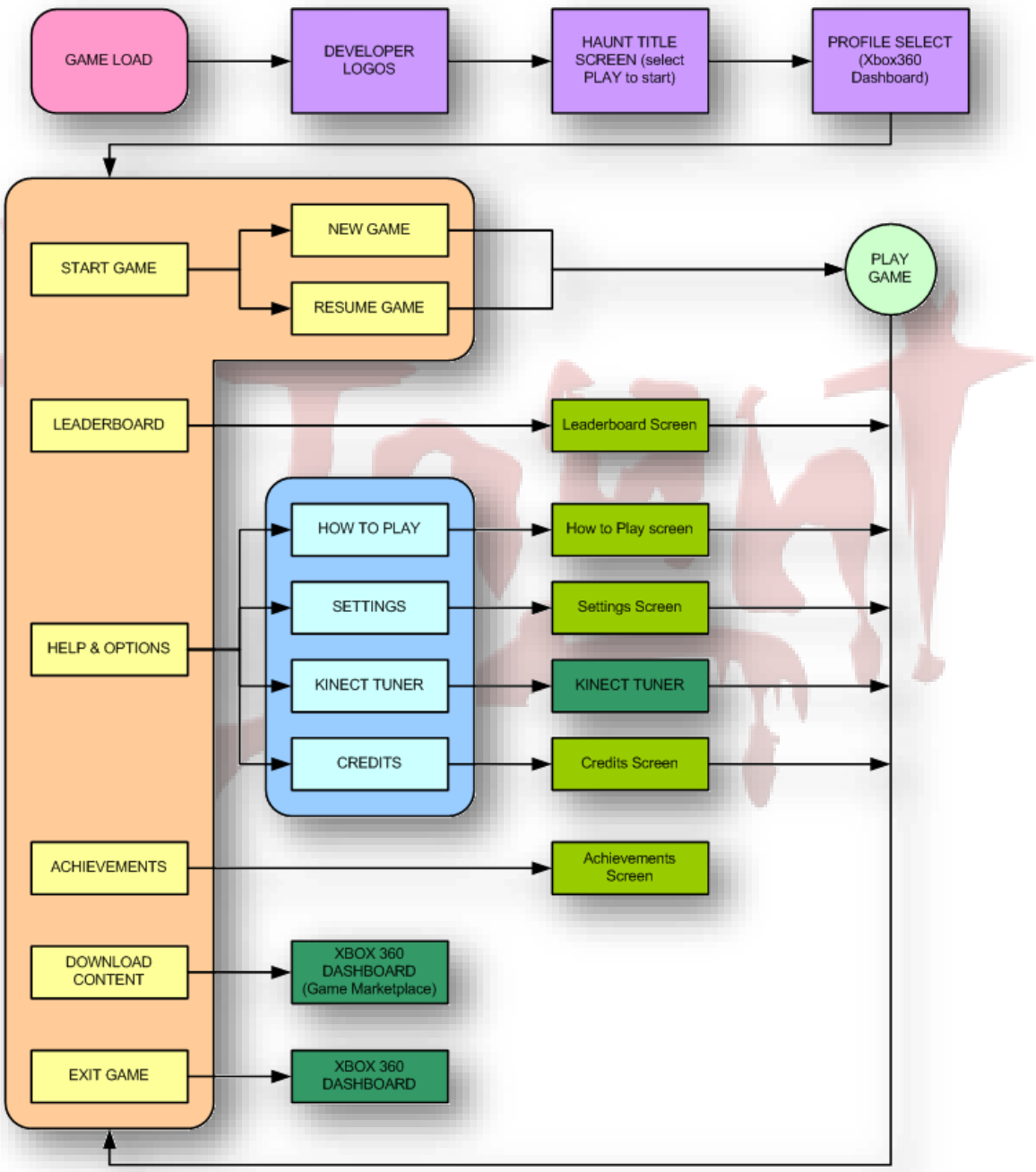
Throughout Haunt, Spirit Essence Vials are hidden in rooms and objects, promoting full exploration. These Spirit Essence Vials, when found, are instantly added to the player's HUD on the right hand side of their Spirit Essence meter, affording the player an extra life for use in the game.

Accordingly, the Extra Vial is a powerful collectible which players will want to search for.



FRONT-END

Haunt's front-end will be similar to that of other XBLA titles; simple and effective, with additional options to cover all of *Haunt*'s features. This section provides an outline for how the game's menus will flow, though some details may be subject to change upon implementation. The diagram below gives a high level view of how *Haunt*'s front-end will appear upon the game being booted:



Starting the Game

Kinect Attention Screens

Upon booting the game, screens that advise on the use of Kinect are seen first. These screens remind players how to set up their play space to get the best from Kinect.

Developer Logos

Logos for Microsoft Game Studios, NanaOn-Sha and Zoë Mode will appear in succession upon booting *Haunt*.

Title Screen

The Title Screen is the first introduction to *Haunt*. It will be themed appropriately and display legal and copyright information. Players can press the '**A**' button on their standard controller, or perform a gesture in front of the Kinect sensor to continue.

Profile Select

Before segueing from the Title Screen to the Main Menu, players are be asked to select their Gamer Profile. The standard Kinect/Xbox 360 Dashboard profile management interface will be used here. *Haunt* will only use one Gamer Profile at a time and the selected profile will be used to store load and save information for the current play session. Achievements and Leaderboard positions will also be awarded to the selected Gamer Profile only. To avoid in-game interruptions, additional players in the room will not be required to sign in with their Gamer Profile.

Players can open the Kinect/Xbox 360 Dashboard at any time whilst playing *Haunt*, and choose to sign out the current Gamer Profile. Upon signing out, the game will return to the Title Screen where the player can sign in again using the Profile Select process and return to the Main Menu.

Main Menu

Players can access all of the features of *Haunt* from the Main Menu. Players are able to navigate options using a wireless controller or Kinect's standard dashboard navigation system. The following options will be available from the Main Menu screen:

- **Story Mode**
  - **Resume Game** – Continue a previously saved game (this option is unavailable if there is no saved game linked to the primary player's gamer profile).
  - **New Game** – Start a new game (this will overwrite the current saved game).
- **Leaderboards** – Selecting this option will open the Leaderboards page, where players can see their score in a table in relation to the scores of other players on Xbox Live.

- **Help & Options**
  - **How to Play** – Selecting this option will provide players with instructions on how to play *Haunt*. What these instructions are and how they are to be implemented is still to be determined.
  - **Settings** – Selecting this option will allow the player to adjust the game's settings, such as Music and SFX volume, Gamma and Assured Navigation.
  - **Kinect Tuner** – Selecting this option will open the Kinect Tuner window where players can the settings of their Kinect device.
  - **Credits –** Selecting this option will run the developer credits.
- **Achievements** – Selecting this option will open the Xbox 360 Achievements dashboard guide for Haunt.
- **Download Content** – This option will provide a shortcut to the XBL Game Marketplace where the player can purchase downloadable content for Haunt (this option will be unavailable if there is no DLC available, or if the available DLC has already been purchased.
- **Exit Game** – Selecting this option will quit the game, taking the player back to the Xbox 360 dashboard.

Pause Menu

Whilst playing *Haunt*, the player can pause the game at any time to see the Pause menu. From there the following options will be available:

- **Resume Game** – Exit the Pause menu and continue with the current game.
- **Help & Options**
  - **Settings** – Selecting this option will allow the player to adjust the game's settings, such as Music and SFX volume. The options that will be available here are still to be determined.
  - **Kinect Tuner** – We could potentially allow players to re-calibrate their Kinect sensor from the Pause menu. The possibility of this is still to be determined once the current navigation method has been signed-off.
- **Exit to Main Menu** – Quits the current game and returns to the Main Menu screen.

Menu Navigation

Kinect Navigation

This will be confirmed during production; however the Kinect navigation will follow the standard interfaces used throughout the Kinect Dashboard and Avatar editor.

Other Front-End Features

Trial Version

An additional option to allow players to purchase the full game will be available from the Trial Version's Main Menu.

Loading Screens

Haunt has a loading screen designed to fit with the artistic style of the game. The user screen ends with a static screen that requires the user to perform a specific Kinect button press. This is accompanied by an on screen message informing the user what to do e.g. "Press 'play' to start."

Achievements

Players can use the Kinect/Xbox 360 Dashboard Guide to check their *Haunt* Achievements.

Upsell Graphic on Exit

Arcade titles are required to show an upsell graphic when a customer exits an Arcade game that is in trial mode.

The upsell graphic will last from 10 to 20 seconds. After it finishes, the user is returned automatically to the dashboard, and not to the game's Main menu. If the game is already unlocked, the upsell graphic will never appear.

Required Up-Sell Times

Haunt will offer upsell opportunities at the following times:

- When an untimed trial runs out of game levels
- When a customer exits the trial

These requirements are in addition to the "Unlock Full Game" Main menu command that is required for trial versions.

Front-End Implementation

The *Haunt* front-end is built using Microsoft's XUI API which has been used successfully on the Xbox 360 dashboard. The core goals of the front-end are:

- Use large Kinect enabled 2D menu items, over a static high resolution 2D scene
- Simple and intuitive flow that makes accessing the game possible in the fewest number of steps
- Have menu items styled to fit in with the artistic theme of the game
- Allow players to navigate with the Xbox 360 controller and Kinect

- Ensure Kinect navigation emulates the already familiar interfaces used in the Xbox Kinect Dashboard
- Follow the recommendations set forth by Microsoft for XBLA menus and navigation systems

XUI

The Xbox 360 User Interface (XUI) system was designed and built for games, consoles, and televisions. It leverages the power of Xbox 360 graphics to provide a 2D user interface in a 3D space with all of the 3D features that the Xbox 360 console provides, such as font rendering, texture filtering, pixel shading, and more. XUI is a stable, well-tested, and highly scalable addition to the XDK.

- Allow the UI to Fit the Artistic Theme of the Title
- Separate the UI Design From Programming
- Provide a Cost-Effective Solution
- Produce a Compact User Interface
- Eliminate Lengthy Turnaround Times
- Provide a Great Localization Solution
- Easily Fit Into Existing Workflow
- Provide a Flexible Font Rendering Solution

SPECTATOR SUPPORT

Haunt is primarily a single player experience, though due to the nature of *Kinect* it is expected that many players will not be playing alone. As such, we intend to focus spectator interactivity functionality on in-the-room participation with friends and family – bringing the whole household into the *Haunt* experience.

It should be noted that any instances of spectator functionality are intrinsic parts of the design. For example, if a player is required to be silent for a period, then by extension everyone in the room is required to be quiet. As a single player game, there are no examples of events or interactions that are geared solely towards spectator play.

In-the-Room Participation

As the primary player continues their game, navigating and interacting with objects in the game world, spectators in the room can add to the experience in a number of ways.

- **Audio Interactions** – During an interaction between the primary player and a ghost, others in the room can aid the player by shouting when the player shouts to repel the ghost, boosting the volume for a more effective attack.
- **Audio Sensitivity** – When the primary player is exploring areas that require them to be quiet as to not attract unwanted attention from ghosts, the overall volume of the room will be a key factor, requiring all in the room to be as quiet as possible – adding to the atmosphere.
- **Audio Sampling** – *Kinect* can take audio samples from the room at discrete points in the game, and later play them back with a spooky effect when everyone in the room isn't expecting it.
- **Movement Sensitivity** – Certain events in the game may require the primary player to move energetically, waving their arms (e.g. bats). In these scenarios *Kinect* looks for additional movement in the room, the more movement detected, the quicker the condition is met.
- **Image Sampling** – Any image of the player which is used in game will use surroundings too, and accordingly will feature any spectators in the room.

In addition, *Kinect* technology makes it easy for players to trade positions without interrupting gameplay and immersion, allowing anyone in the room to take over from the primary player whenever they want a break.

Examples of these forms of multiplayer participation can be found in the stage designs featured in the separate 'Haunt – Level Design Document' document.

ONLINE FUNCTIONALITY

Haunt does not support multiplayer online play, however there are several aspects of the game that do utilize the functionality provided by Xbox LIVE.

Xbox Achievements

- *Haunt* will offer 200 Gamerscore through 12 Xbox Achievements
- Achievements follow the guidelines provided by Microsoft in their documentation

The achievements in Haunt are as follows:

Achievement Name	Achieved Condition	Score
So we begin…	Return the Tutorial Magic Talisman	15
Hear, hear!	Return the Sound Magic Talisman	15
…and there was light	Return the Light & Dark Magic Talisman	15
So very moving	Return the Motion Magic Talisman	15
The End	Complete the game	30
Easy when you know how	Defeat one of each type of ghost	10
Framed!	Pose for a photo and then admire the picture	10
Reel Scared	Find and play back the ghost train footage	10
Hello?	Answer the ringing telephone	10
Hardcore	Complete the game without using a Spirit Essence vial.	40
Newshound	Collect all 7 newspaper clippings in the game	20
Outta My Way!	Successfully avoid 5 Charger ghost attacks	10

Included Achievement Types

Achievements will focus on the following types in order of preference:

- **Carrots** – Awarded upon the completion of a "level" or any other significant task
- **Mode Exploration** – Awarded as incentives to try all that the game has to offer
- **Hidden Treasures** – Awarded for finding hidden items, and completing collections

Online Leaderboards

Haunt's Story Mode will support an online leaderboard, showing players' scores ranked with other players. For more details on score, see the scoring section of this document.

Leaderboard Views

The following three leaderboard views will be available for the player to cycle through. Friends will be the default view.

- **Friends View –** Shows the scores for the current player, and all of the player's friends who have scores posted on the leaderboard. The leaderboard also needs to show every player's overall ranking, not just rankings against friends.
- **My Score View** – Shows the portion of the overall leaderboard that includes the current player's score. It also needs to highlight that score.
- **Overall View** – Shows the portion of the overall leaderboard that includes the top player on the leaderboard. The top player's score needs to be highlighted.

Rich Presence

Xbox 360 rich presence requirements include:

- *Haunt* must provide at least one rich presence string per major play mode
- *Haunt* can have up to a maximum of 16 customizable rich presence strings
- Each rich presence string can consist of a maximum of two lines of text, and each line can have a maximum of 22 characters including contexts and properties
- Each rich presence string, including its associated localized versions, can contain up to a maximum of eight contexts and properties total

Rich Presence in *Haunt* will follow the below guidelines and use strings that:

- Generate interest in a game for new players as well as casual players who might have missed a special feature
- Motivate players to take action
- Empower gamers to show off their achievements, such as completion of levels or discovery of secret areas
- Use localized contexts so that Xbox 360 gamers around the world can be a part of the community you are trying to foster
- Do not use properties or contexts that change rapidly

The Rich Presence strings that will be used for Haunt are detailed as follows:

String	Condition
In the Grand Hall	The player is in the grand hall at any time after the tutorial
In the Auditory Annex	The player is playing in any part of the Sound Level
In the Light & Dark Annex	The player is playing in any part of the Light and Dark Level
In the Motion Annex	The player is playing in any part of the Motion Level

TRIAL VERSION RESTRICTIONS

Trial Version

Trial versions have the following gamerestrictions:

- Users must not be able to save their game state[1]
- Users must not be able to earn any achievements or Gamerscore. Trial versions can indicate when a player would have earned an achievement. They can also offer to award an achievement if the player immediately unlocks the full game
- Users must not be able to post leaderboard scores that they earn
- If a trial version includes a timed demo, a countdown of the remaining time must be shown. Users must be allowed to replay a timed demo with a full clock even if they have previously run out of time
- Although trial versions cannot allow gamers to post scores, they should still allow gamers to see online leaderboards, and access Xbox LIVE functionality

[1] This restriction does not apply to user preferences. Trial versions can allow players to store user preferences and control mappings

KINECT USER EXPERIENCE CONSIDERATIONS

Haunt needs to consider the implications, should Kinect data become unreliable or difficult to detect, and provide positive and intuitive mechanisms to assist the player.

Behavior when skeleton is lost

When the skeleton is lost, the game will automatically pause and wait for the player to be reacquired before accepting further input. This will be indicated to the player via on-screen prompts in line with the visual style of the game so the player is not pulled away from the immersive *Haunt* environment they are exploring.

Behavior at edges of the play space

A player avatar is not visible in *Haunt* and so the game will need to use other visual and audible hints to warn the player that they approaching the edge of the playing space.

These effects will be gradual and increase in intensity the closer the player gets so they can adjust their position before the skeleton is completely lost, yet not be pulled away from the game environment.

DLC

This section details potential content for *Haunt* that could be sold as downloadable content through Xbox Live. At this stage these are ideas only, and as such are not to be considered part of our current plan.

Level Packs

By downloading an additional Level Pack for *Haunt*, players could receive:

- 1 additional *Haunt* level with a new Side Story and VO
- A new main Character/Villain
- 1 new Ghost type, with new animations
- New Object Interactions
- New Scares
- New player Attack/Defense Interactions

Level Packs would need to be costed based on the specific type and amount of new content provided, but initial estimates indicate that these could be produced for around *USD 100,000* to *150,000* per pack. Each pack would require approximately 2 months of development to complete. By utilising staff leaving the project post the Content Complete milestone, the first of these could be developed in time for release soon after launch of the original game. Once the project is complete, any further packs could be developed in parallel as desired.

Super Scary Mode

Potentially, we could release a new play mode as DLC. This new mode would enhance the game for braver players looking for more scary experience. The following parameters could be modified to provide such a mode:

- Increased frequency of scares
- Changes to lighting effects so that the mansion appears more intimidating.
- Increased volume for sound effects used for surprise scares.
- New scare types (focusing on a more mature audience)

As this new game mode could largely be handled by tweaks to the current game parameters, with some bespoke content for new scares, the cost would be considerably less than a Level Pack. Current estimates indicate an approximate development cost of *USD 40,000 to 50,000*, to be ready for release soon after the original game.